

issues that you find generally leading to misunderstandings?

The doctor-patient relationship is based on trust. The patient has the right to get a second opinion, but tend to get too many opinions that leads to delay in treatment and could cause some complications. General surgery or be any speciality, the patient comes to the hospital to get treatment and is aware that there are bound to be some complications. It is the responsibility of the doctor to be transparent while explaining in detail about the possible complications and the also the estimated cost to be explained by the hospital staff. Lack of communication is what leads to mistrust.

Which are the common diseases where surgery becomes inevitable?

There are few diseases which can be treated with medical management while in some surgery is the only option e.g., hernia, cholecystitis, appendicitis, symptomatic gall stones, abscess, varicose veins with ulcer, gangrene etc. Surgery is a specialised branch of medicine and with advancements there is less pain and post-operative complications. So, there is no need to worry that your problem has surgery as the only solution.

What are the latest cutting-edge technology available at your hospital and the specialties that they cover apart from diagnostic capabilities?

In the armamentarium of Shanmuga Hospital, we have Philips intuit Cath lab, which is very helpful in doing coronary, neuro and peripheral angiogram and also to treat the conditions. Our latest laparoscopic equipment like Aesculap and Karl Storz is used in surgeries, whereas the cardiac bypass machine, IABP machine is meant for coronary surgery. Olympus ERCP for biliary procedures, flexible bronchoscope for airway pathologies, two linear accelerators for radiotherapy. CT scan, USG

guided biopsies are done. Philips MRI embedded cutting-edge technology is used to diagnose and treat early stroke cases. Dialysis machines is used to treat chronic kidney diseases. Drager monitors, ventilators, infusion and syringe pumps are available for sick patients. For smooth anaesthesia there is Drager workstations for all OT. Covidien electrocautery for Operation theatre with ligasure and harmonic facilities ensure safe surgeries. The list is exhaustive in medical field as you need to update the new machines every five years and investment is always high in hospital service industry due to installation of new machines that are exorbitant in costs.

Training, teaching and skilling are fundamental to ensure a highly professional staff. What are your contributions in these areas?

We conduct regular classes for clinical to medical students and staffs. The clinical material include eBooks available in UpToDate site accessible anywhere from hospital. Classes for soft skills such as communication skills are also held for the staffs. Emphasis is also given on every staff member attending regular conferences, workshops in their respective fields, which is a major requisite in their performance appraisal. Moreover, we conduct regular conference for other general practioners. We being a DNB training institute in general surgery, radiotherapy and emergency medicine, we ensure that trainings are a part of our work culture.

Could you share about the milestones achieved by you as a laparoscopic and laser surgery expert, and the impact it has made in patient care and treatment?

Minimally invasive surgery /laparoscopic surgery has transformed the way surgeries are done and commonly used throughout the world. At our hospital all regular surgeries are done

laparoscopically whenever possible and depending upon the affordability of the patient. From simple lap surgeries to appendix, gall bladder, hernia to advanced surgeries like fundoplication, hemicolectomy, anterior resection is been done laparoscopically in our hospital. We also do LASER for varicose vein, fissure, fistula, piles, but the results are exceptionally good for varicose veins.

Shanmuga Hospital is known to be the first cancer hospital, as early as the 90's, in the region. How has it transformed the healthcare landscape, the humanitarian initiatives that it has undertaken, and the vision forward from here?

Our cancer department was started in times when there were hardly 4-5 cancer centre in Tamil Nadu. We were the first cancer treatment providing hospital in surrounding 8 districts beginning with one doctor in 1996. The department has all onco specialities like medical, surgical and radiation oncology with DNB residents and has transformed into a centre of excellence with a team of oncologist finalising and approving a tailor-made treatment for each patient. From treating one hundred patients per year, we have now grown in capabilities to treat 4000 patients per year. The recent advancements in oncology and better outcomes have also helped to change the mindset of people on coming to our hospital. Previously whenever someone was diagnosed with cancer, which was considered equal to death sentence nowadays death from cancer is very negligible that has raised the confidence of people to get treated.

On World Cancer Day held on 4th February, we invite cancer survivors to motivate patients who are recently diagnosed with cancer. There are clinical psychologists, occupational therapists and speech therapists who are also involved in the treatment plan so that the patient gets a holistic care.

